

The Unsaid

elevated pre-arrival service blueprint

POLYU DES•GN

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- // First_of_all -

Let’s Imagine...



- // Once_upon_a_time / Now -

You are the CEO of a luxury hotel

Differentiate from others

// Competitors are competing
// Beyond staying in a room



Raise the brand equity

// Be the one in the market
// Select brand believers



Earning a profit

// No bankrupt
// Low cost and extra income



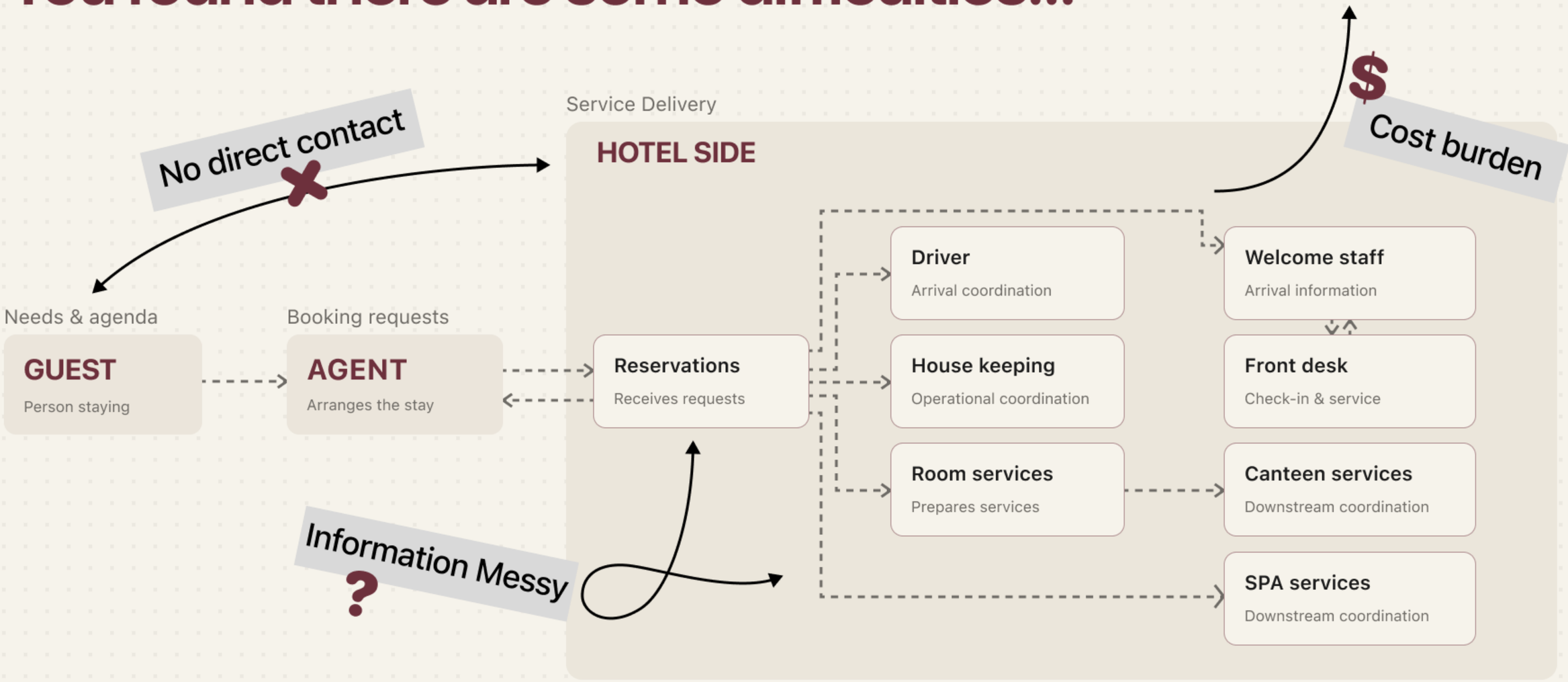
- // Because_of_that -

Targeting the high-net-worth customers

- Most of them are guests **with peer influence**
  //Some are KOC/KOL
  //Social circles, network promotion
- Greater **revenue potential** beyond room bookings
  //Dining, spa and personalised experiences
  //Repeat stays and long-term guest value
- **Winning their loyalty** can strengthen luxury positioning.
  //Reinforce the brand's prestige
  //Build aspiration among a wider audience

- // One_day -

You found there are some difficulties...



- // Because_of_that -

You are trying to find a solution.

No direct contact

//Find latent needs
//Try to build a channel

⟷

Information Messy

//Ensure delivery quality
//Build a new work flow

⟷

Cost burden

//Limited labors and trainings
//Automation

This is all about

Balancing among **latent needs service**, **delivery quality** and **cost managment**.

- // It_sounds_like_an_impossible_triangle_but -

That is how we understand the brief given by MO.

We are solving for

pre-arrival service that helps guests feel recognised and can be delivered reliably at manageable cost and complexity,

in service of

Mandarin Oriental's goal of strengthening brand equity and guests' willingness to pay.

Focus Group

//5% hotel customers
//Pearl VIPs
//High net worth

Location

//HK Mandarin Oriental
//Urban Type

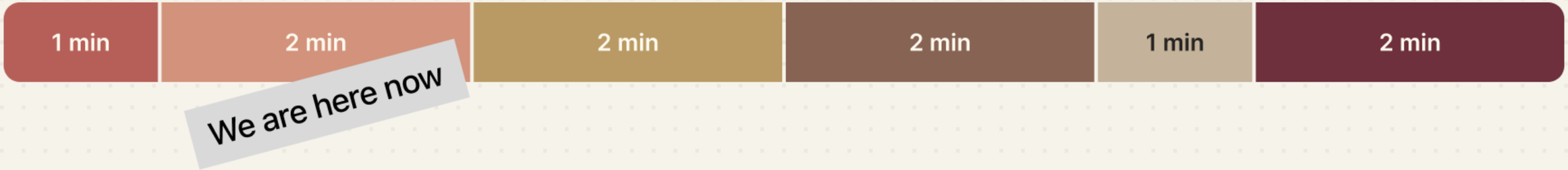


- // And_look_back_to_the_story -

The story is not just made up,
It is actually from our research findings.

today's_presentation

10 MIN

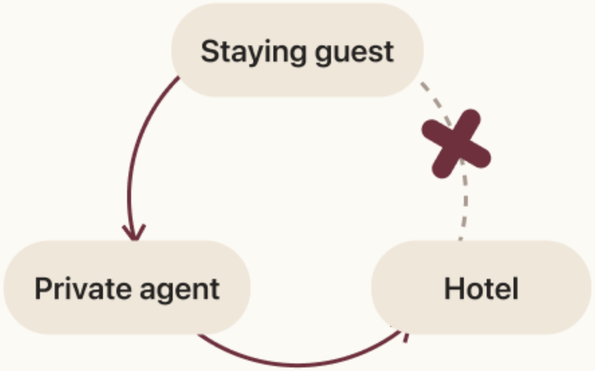


00:00	Opening: a story	1 min
01:00	Research findings & Service blueprint	2 min
03:00	Design introduction 1	2 min
05:00	Design introduction 2	2 min
07:00	Influence & Risks	1 min
08:00	Q&A session	2 min

- // Two_key_insights_the_first_is -

Three roles in a booking.

1 · INFORMATION AMONG THREE ROLES



Information: Guest → Agent → Hotel

Limited direct contact at booking

2 · MO ONLINE INTERVIEW

95%

book through private agents

Among the **5%** high-net-worth segment we focus on.

Source: MO online interview · 16 Sep
Interview-reported data

3 · OFFLINE INTERVIEWS & OBSERVATIONS

4 / 5

said their agents booked their stay

5 guests that are matching our high-net-worth profile.

Source: HK MO lobby interviews · 12 Sep
Small sample · n = 5



- // Because_of_that -

The agent is the key.

1 · THREE PERSONAL AGENTS



Ms. Zhao
Personal agent
Job title: Xiaomi EV



Ms. Chen
Personal agent
Job title: Agent of the CEO



Ms. Zhang
Personal agent
Job title: Personal Assistant



2 · WHAT WE HEARD

"We usually call or use WeChat to confirm the requests."

"Small details often need repeated back-and-forth."

"Texting always takes time and makes me less willing to explain more needs."

"Sometimes it is easier to arrange things for the boss by ourselves."

Source: personal agent interviews
Paraphrased interview feedback

3 · COMMUNICATION TIME

>5 min

to coordinate special requests when booking for the boss

WeChat | Call | Online



- // The_second_key_finding_is -

The Dream Maker in MO Shenzhen.

1 · DISCOVERED IN SHENZHEN

Care beyond the booking.

During our Shenzhen MO visit, we met the Dream Maker: a guest-facing role that uncovers unspoken needs and creates tangible moments of care and surprise.

Online request can never predict.

These needs are emerged in the moment. Online booking — even with a detailed agent briefing — cannot fully capture this context.

Source: Shenzhen MO site visit · Team observation



- // The_second_key_finding_is -

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2 · Limited contacting time

5–8 min

For limited contact time and room for needs discovery

11/16

complaints concerned situation-based services (room / restaurant / package)

Sources:
SabeeApp (2024); Google review · n=16

5–8 min: check-in reference only.

3 · FRAGMENTED HANDOFFS

NO Standard SOP

Similar roles. Different workflows.

Follow-up interviews found similar roles across the hotels discussed, but no shared, efficient process for consolidating insights and passing them between departments.

Source: MO online interview · 16 Sep
Team synthesis · hotels discussed

- // This_gives_a_new_perspective -

Two gaps. One shared goal.

GAP 01 · ONLINE BOOKING

Texting leaves needs unsaid.

Repeated texting discourages agents from sharing more specific needs.

GAP 02 · IN-PERSON OBSERVATION

Observation needs a shared process.

Brief contact and inconsistent handoffs limit the discovery and sharing of situational needs.

→

ONE SHARED INTENT

Better pre-arrival customization.

Prepare care online.
Refine it in person.

Build recognition.

Online booking lays the foundation for knowing the guest.

Memorize recognition.

In-person observation adds a unique touch to reveal what matters in the moment.

→

RESPONSE 01 · PERSONAL AGENT

Help agents say more.

Design a visual booking flow to help agents express specific needs faster.

Partner with agents; aim to limit extra hotel effort.

RESPONSE 02 · DREAM MAKER

Connect earlier. Share better.

Design a standard SOP to help Dream Makers engage earlier and observe guests in context.

Record preferences in one shared guest profile.

- // Further_more -

The guest actually check the whole process.

ONE USER · THE STAYING GUEST



Guests check the **basics that build recognition** throughout the journey; **unique touches** in the room's **first minute** can make it **memorable** and sharply **lift satisfaction**.

RESEARCH SUPPORT

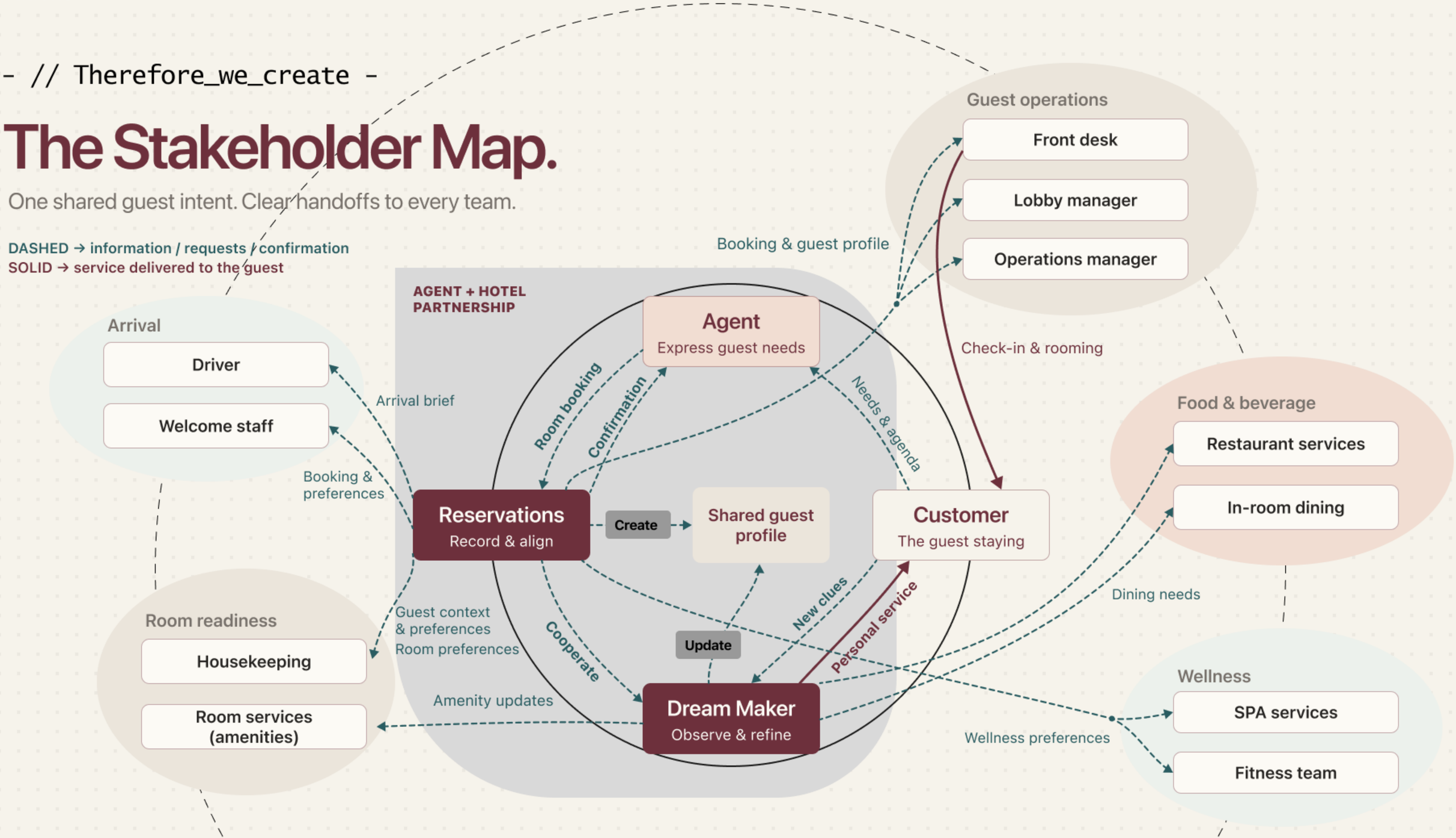
Oliver (1980) · checking expectations
Kano et al. (1984) · basics versus delight
Verhoef et al. (2009) · cumulative experience

- // Therefore_we_create -

The Stakeholder Map.

One shared guest intent. Clear handoffs to every team.

DASHED → information / requests / confirmation
SOLID → service delivered to the guest



- // and -

Service Blueprint.

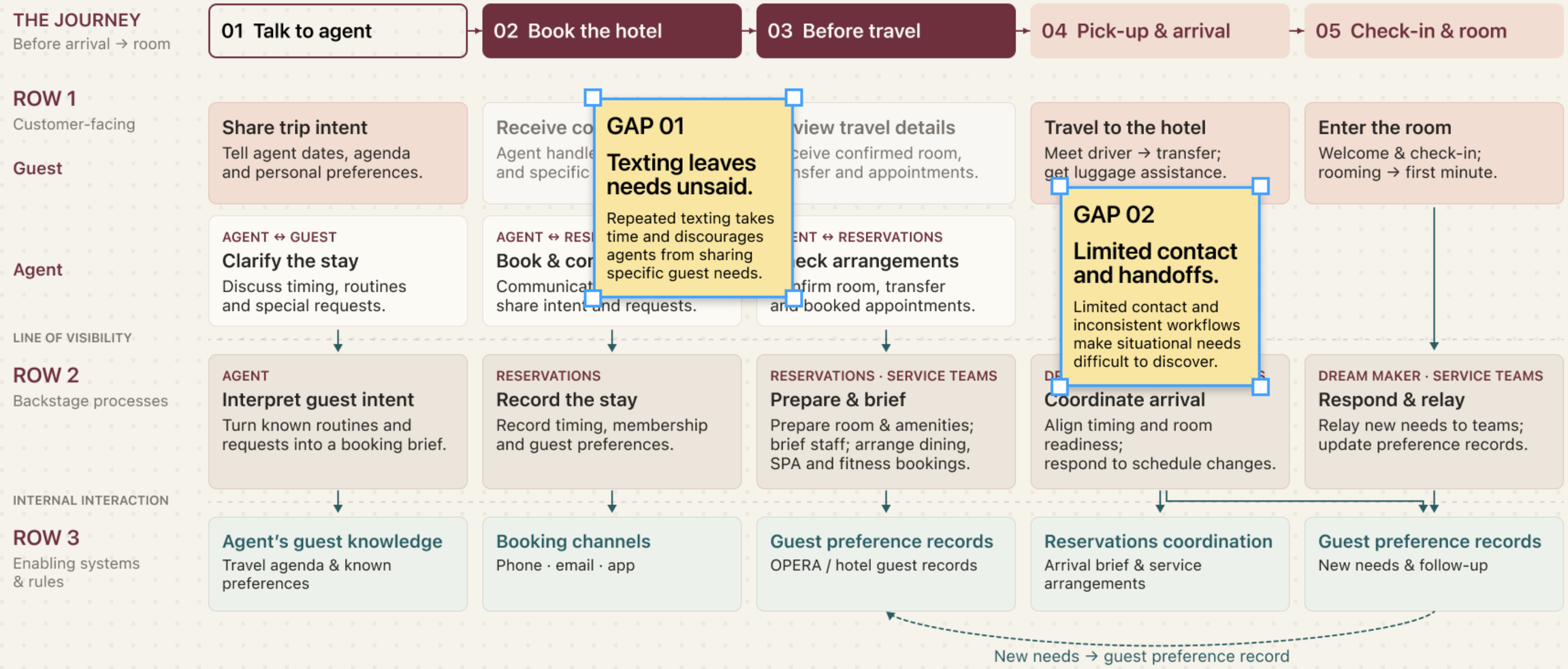
From a booking brief to the guest's first minute in the room.



- // and -

Service Blueprint.

From a booking brief to the guest's first minute in the room.



- // For_agent_and_guest -

Easier to Speak for the Guest

Bring the agent into the service loop without adding more work.

Easy to Express

Make guest needs easier for agents to communicate.

Playful to Explore

Turn preference selection into a lighter, more engaging experience.

Flexible to Personalize

Leave room and services for different needs and levels of detail.

Less effort. More discovery. More personal.

- // Focus_on_the_purpose -

From Purpose to Preference

Guests may not always know what they need — and agents may not know what to ask.

Stay Purpose → Relevant Preference Areas → Playful Exploration & Choice → Structured Preferences

Instead of asking agents to describe every preference from scratch, the booking flow surfaces what may matter based on the purpose of the stay.

- // Theme_matters -

Designed Around the Journey

Different journeys make different preferences relevant, so each booking starts with a curated setup shaped around the purpose of the stay.



- // Dimension_1 -

Two Dimensions Behind Every Setup

Dimension 1 — Service Scope

L1 **Standard Setup**

Standard room amenities and routine adjustments.

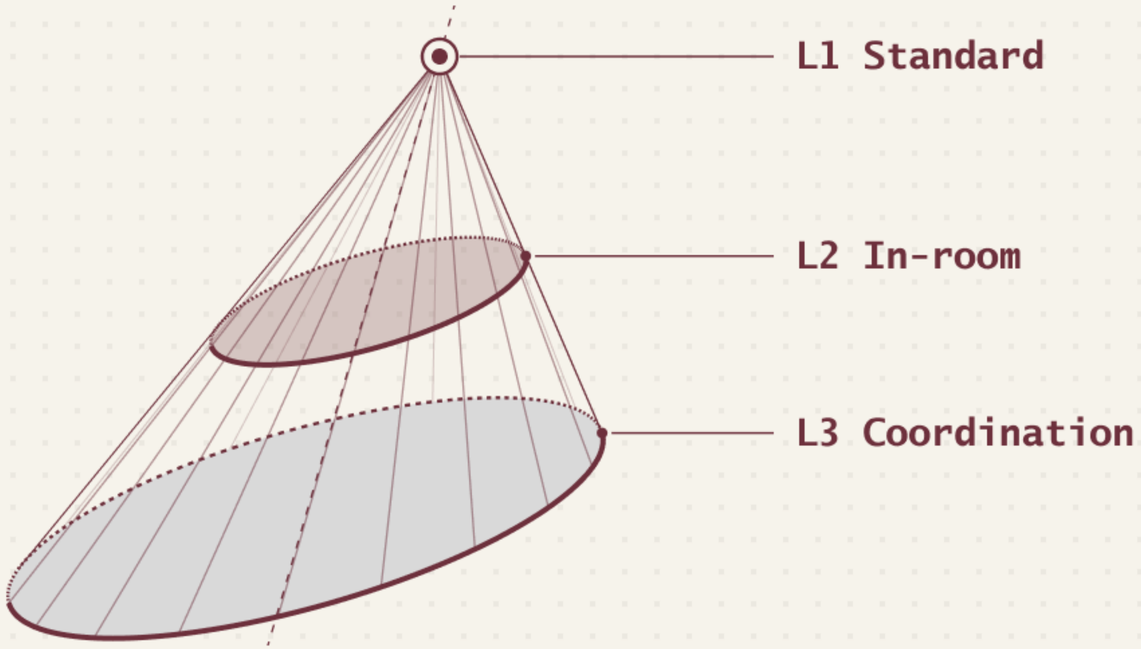
L2 **Additional In-Room Setup**

Extra amenities and arrangements beyond the standard setup.

L3 **Extended Services**

Coordinated by the Dream Maker

Services requiring coordination with other hotel departments or external partners by dream maker.



Service scope expands from standard room preparation to additional in-room arrangements and beyond-room services.

- // Dimension_2 -

Two Dimensions Behind Every Setup

Dimension 2 — Degree of Personalization

01 **Default Setup**

A scenario-specific baseline prepared by the hotel.

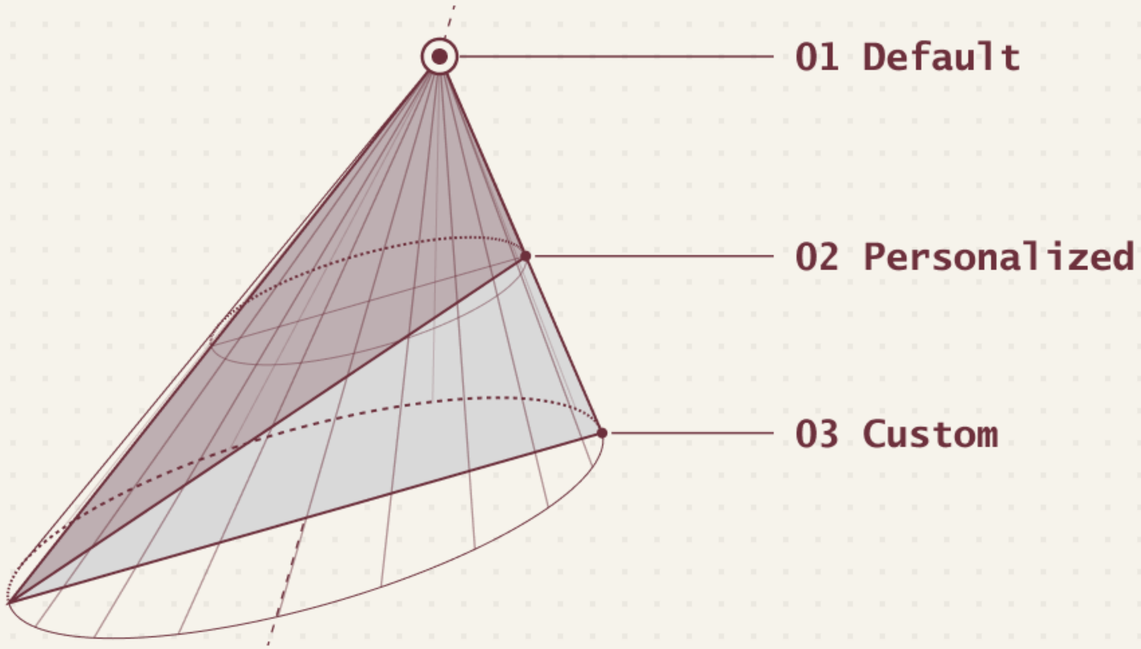
02 **Agent-Personalized Setup**

Elements personalized by the agent based on known guest information.

03 **Custom Requests**

Coordinated by the Dream Maker

Needs that require coordination with other hotel departments and Dream Maker follow-up.



Personalization moves from a prepared baseline to agent-informed adjustments and fully custom requests.

- // The_universal_structure -

One Scenario, One Preset Table

The same two-dimensional structure creates a different preset for each stay purpose.

	Default Setup	Agent-Personalized Setup	Custom Requests
L1 — Rest	Quiet sleep environment with minimal interruption	Pillow, room temperature and lighting preferences	Special sleep arrangements
L1 — Desk	Work-ready desk with charging points and office essentials	Additional stationery, such as pens, paper and notepads.	Special workspace arrangements
L2 — Meeting Menu	Business meeting setup options	Guest number, timing and beverage preferences	Complex meeting setup and cross-department coordination
L3 — Restaurant	—	Restaurant reservation and preferred dining time	Special menu, table arrangement and dining coordination

Selected modules from Business Trip — In Your Zone

— // THE DEMO

Your stay.
Made personal.

Explore a business stay,
shaped around the guest.

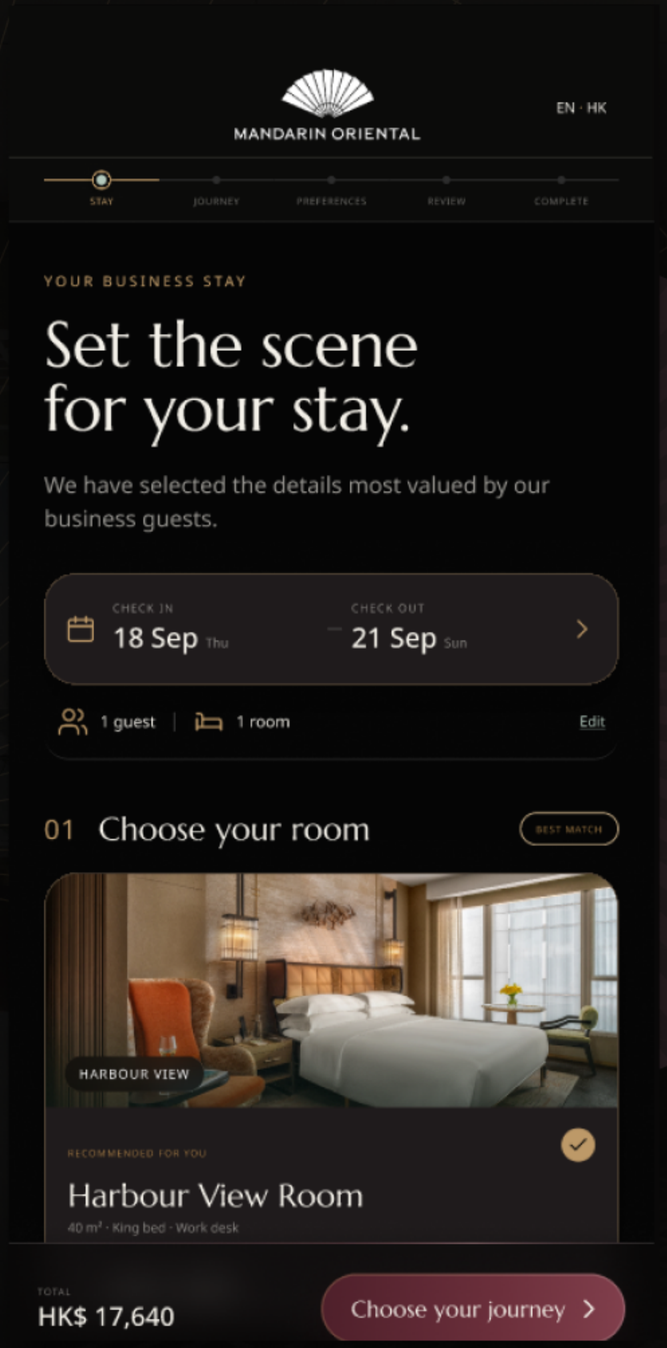
Explore the app

Preset → Personalize → Explore

Scan to explore the prototype
and personalize a stay
at your own pace.

Please open in Safari or Chrome.

Simple for the agent.
Personal for the guest.



- // To_recap -

Different Journeys, One Simple Flow

Business Trip
In Your Zone
Focus / Efficiency / Recovery

Birthday
Your Day, Your Way
Celebration / Personal Touches

Honeymoon
A World for Two
Romance / Celebration

Anniversary
Our Story
Memory / Celebration

Family Stay
Together, Made Easy
Convenience / Shared Time

Leisure
Unwind Your Way
Rest / Comfort / Exploration



View All Presets
Scan to explore the full setup for each journey.

Preset >> **Personalize** >> **Explore**

Complex behind the scenes. Simple for the agent. Personal for the guest.

- // The_second_gap -

What is a Dream Maker?

Turning potential delight points into an unexpected, personalised experience.

01 NOTICE

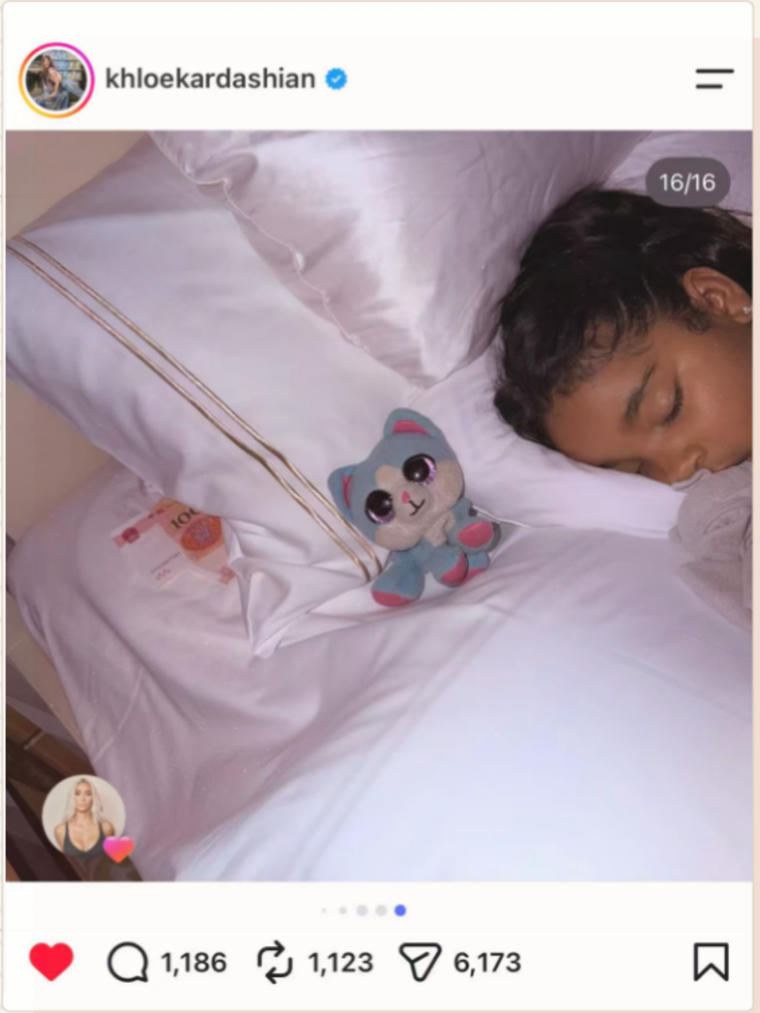
Identify potential delight points

Notice meaningful details that reveal opportunities for personal care.

02 DELIGHT

Create unexpected, personalised delight

Turn a thoughtful gesture into a personal moment the guest remembers.



From attentive observation to a memorable, personalised experience.

- // One_sentence -

“

AGENT ENSURES THE SERVICE BASELINE.

DREAM MAKER ENSURES THE SERVICE CEILING

”

- // Dream_maker -

Current Workflow & Challenges

Dream making relies heavily on individual judgement and personal creativity.



Personal expertise drives each surprise, but learning does not consistently become shared knowledge.

- // Dream_maker -

How might we...

From information gap to a service opportunity.

> help Dream Makers recognise emerging guest preferences and turn them into timely, feasible hotel responses?

- // Dream_maker -

Three natural interactions

From a guest signal to a shared service response.

01 DISCOVER

Combine Agent information with signals emerging during arrival.

02 ARRANGE

DM selects a feasible response and coordinates the hotel team.

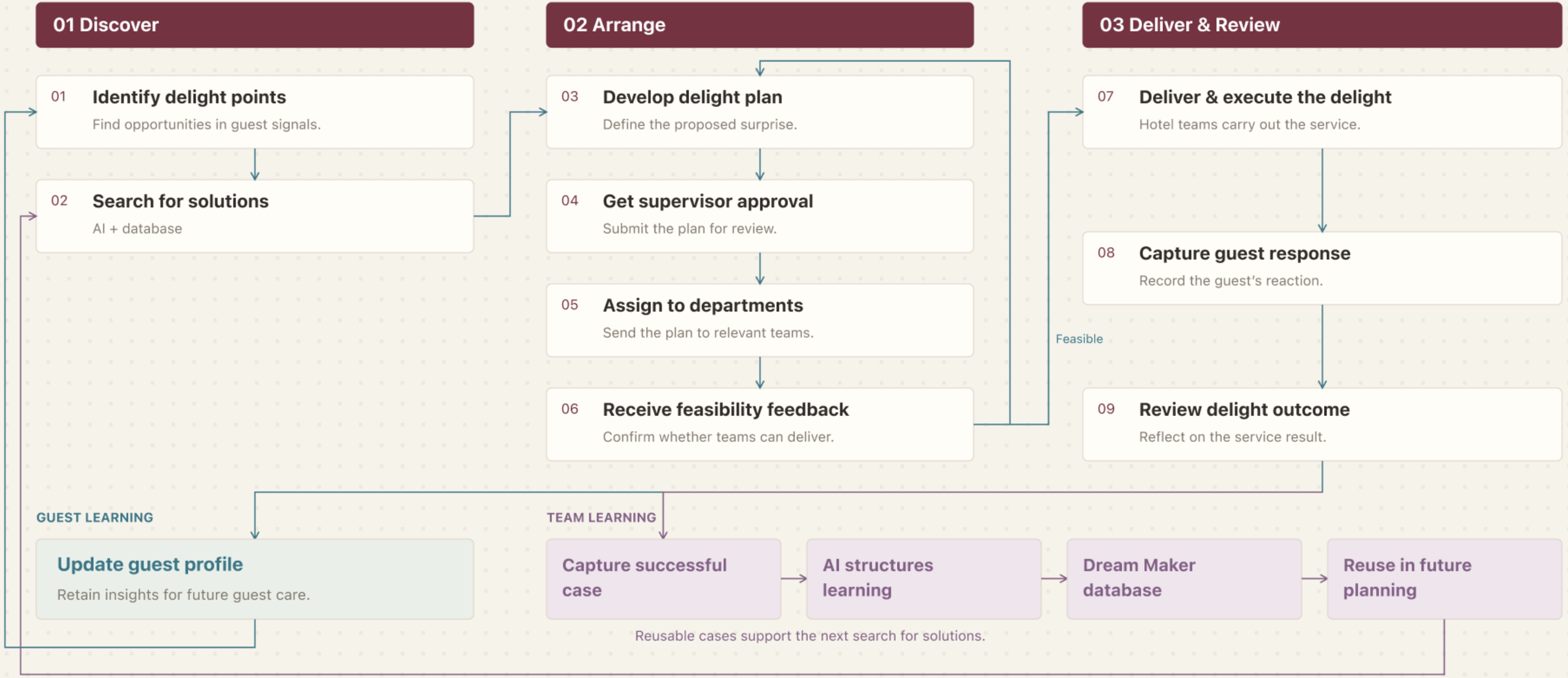
03 EXECUTE

The team delivers; DM records the outcome for future learning.

- // Dream_maker -

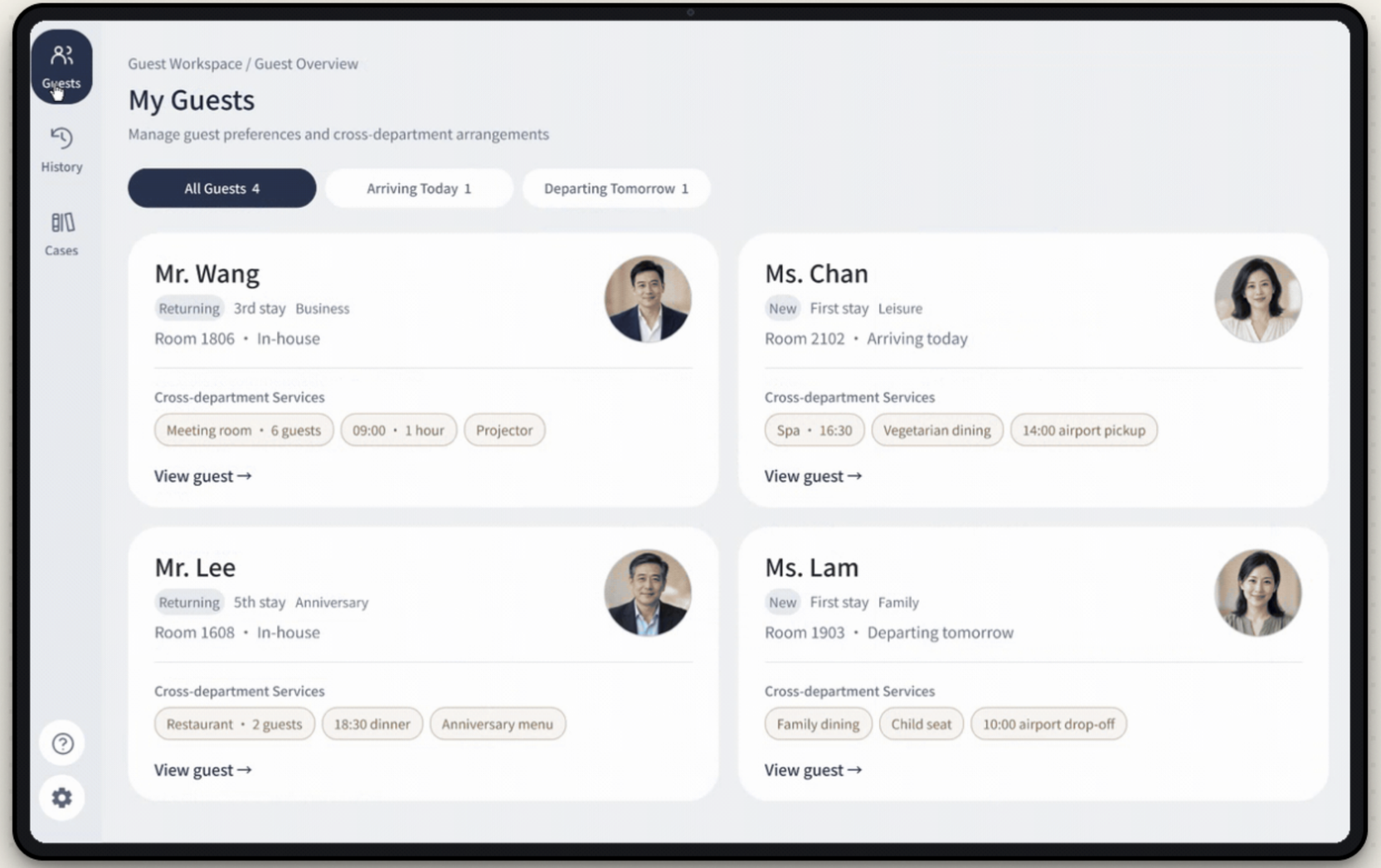
From Delight Signals to Shared Learning

A connected workflow for planning surprises, coordinating delivery and retaining learning.



- // Dream_maker -

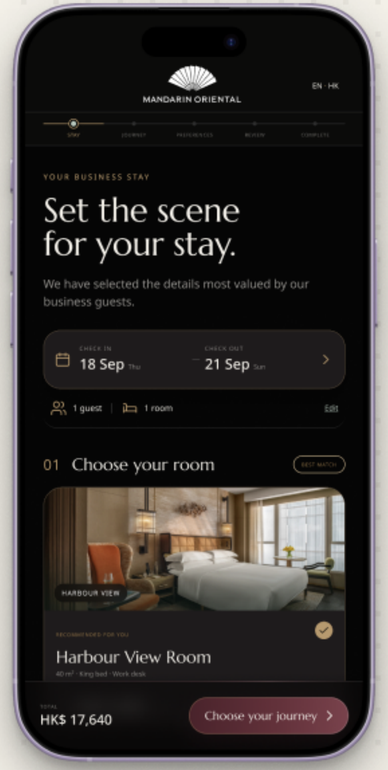
The Workspace We Create



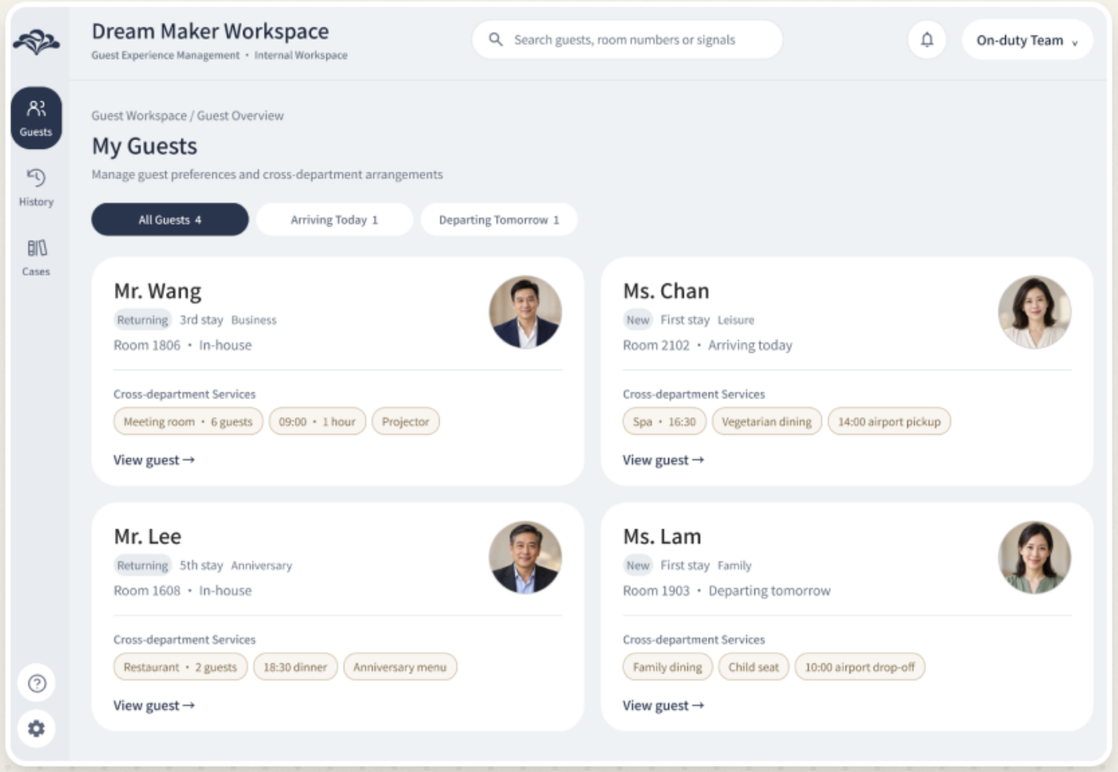
Scan the QR code to try it out

- // Here_They_Are -

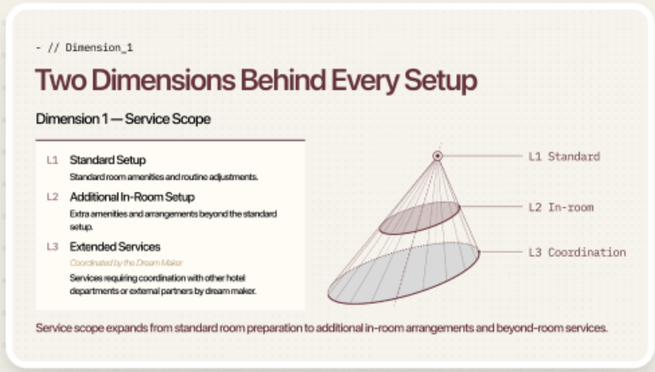
Recapping Our Two Interactive Touchpoints

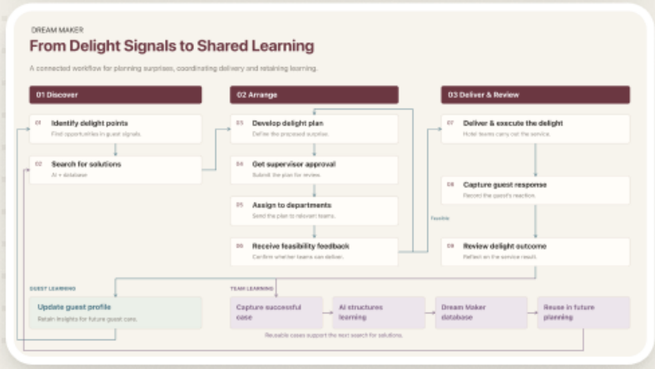


Lightweight, Standalone
Web Interface



Intuitive
Butler Service Backend





Streamlined
SOPs

- // Until_finally -

Expected Business Outcomes

High-Net-Worth & Agent Retention Rate*: **+ 15% ~ 25%**	Seamless pre-booking customization + On-site butler surprises Drives high-touch customer loyalty	Assumption
Requirement Capture Rate: **89.5% → 97.5%**	using visual options that guide guest needs while ensuring hotel delivery	Source: Survey Methodology Research on Item Nonresponse (e.g., Dillman et al., Tailored Design Method). Open-ended formats typically yield 9–12% non-response due to cognitive load, whereas closed-ended options reduce non-response to <2%.
Special Request Entry Time: **5 mins → 3 mins**	Replaces tedious manual typing with visual options, reducing input time while delivering far clearer requests	Source: User Interviews
Offline Service Complaints **11 → 0**	Eliminates misalignments between booking and arrival (addresses 11/16 historical offline complaints)	Source: Data from third-party booking platforms

- // Yet_Realistically -

Risks & Considerations

System Development & Maintenance Costs

To Make It Real : Minimize Cost

// Deploy lightweight & standalone web pages
// Plug into existing MO booking channels

Staffing & Butler Training Costs

To Make It Real : Shorten the learning curve

// Intuitive backend interface
// Streamlined SOPs

Prototype Testing & Fulfillment Boundaries

To Make It Real : Test & Integrate

// Validate feasibility and user experience
// Integrate real-time inventory tracking to manage guest expectations



Q&A

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